

STATEMENT OF INTENDED USE
OF
INTERVIEW RECORDING

Date 27 May 1979

I, William G. Hutchinson, interviewer in the matter of the existence of US PW/MIA's in Southeast Asia, hereby state that any tape recordings made by me of this interview are to be, and will be, used only as an aid to preparing a comprehensive report for the Office of PW/MIA Affairs, United States Department of Defense.

Tôi, William G. Hutchinson, là người phỏng vấn về sự hiện hữu của những tù binh và quân nhân Mỹ mất tích tại Đông Nam Á, này cho biết rõ ràng những đồng ghi âm nào của tôi thu trong sự phỏng vấn này chỉ để, và nhất định chỉ sẽ, được sử dụng làm phương tiện để lập báo cáo có tính chất báo hăm cho Cục Sự Vụ Tù Binh Và Mất Tích của Bộ Quốc Phòng Hoa Kỳ.

Signature/ Ký Tên

PERMISSION
TO
RECORD INTERVIEW

I, SC, the person being interviewed by Mr. William G. Hutchinson in the matter of the existence of US PW/MIA's in Southeast Asia, grant my permission for said interview to be recorded on tape for the purpose of preparing a report for the United States Department of Defense.

Tôi, SC, là người được William G. Hutchinson phỏng vấn về sự hiện hữu của những tù binh và quân nhân Mỹ mất tích tại Đông Nam Á, cho phép thu bằng cuộc phỏng vấn trên để lập báo cáo cho Bộ Quốc Phòng Hoa Kỳ.

Signature/ Ký Tên

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TRANSLATION

SD 1/30/1979

To Mrs. Le Thi Anh

Date
Date

Dear Madame,

Thank you for your concern. I am not, however, afraid of the Communists even though I still have an old mother, a sister, and her child. My mother is too old to be arrested by the Communists anyway.

I contacted my uncle (his name is Sc in Saigon, and I met the person in charge of the Quang Ngai prison also in Saigon. I am willing to meet the families of American prisoners of war, and officials of the Department of Defense. As you know though, Americans always want to have proofs. In that case, where can I get them? I will talk to them anyway.

Another thing I would like to mention is that when Americans landed in Son Tay to rescue American prisoners, the prisons were empty. Everybody then thought that the Communists had already known beforehand, and transferred the prisoners to another place. It was not the case. It was because the prisons were too small, and there were so many prisoners, so the Communists had to move them to another place. It happened shortly before Americans landed in Son Tay. This shook Ha Noi and Ho Chi Minh though. The question was that what if Americans landed in Bac Bo Phu. The Communist Central Military Committee really blamed the Defense Unit for this. My uncle was a high-ranking officer, hence he knew all about this. He also said that one of the helicopters hit the trees and fell, the others landed to rescue the pilots while the Communists did not even have time to react. This proved that they did not know anything about the American landing in Son Tay.

I am willing to talk to the families of prisoners of war, and officials of the Department of Defense. I am enrolled in CETA program. Please write to them so that I can get permission to leave.

I wish you luck and happiness, and hope we can go back to Vietnam sooner.

Sincerely,

Sc signed

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT		
NATIONAL SECURITY INFORMATION Unauthorized Disclosure Subjects to Criminal Sanctions	UNCLASSIFIED Classification/Control Markings	This report contains unprocessed information. Plans and/or policies should not be evolved or modified solely on basis of this report.
1. COUNTRY: VIETNAM (VM)	2. REPORT NUMBER: 2 240 5001-79	
3. TITLE: Alleged Sighting of US Persons in the SRV	4. PROJECT NUMBER: 206200	
5. DATE OF INFORMATION: 750900-770300	6. DATE OF REPORT: 790806	
7. DATE & PLACE OF ACQUISITION: 790504 Washington, D.C.	8. REFERENCES: T-4HX-49018 (Cont)	
9. ASSESSMENT: SOURCE F, INFO 6	10. ORIGINATOR: USA OPERATIONAL GROUP, INSCOM Ft. Meade, MD 20755	
11. REQUEST EVALUATION: OPO (country)	12. PREPARING OFFICER: WM. G. HUTCHINSON C/S, 206200	13. APPROVING AUTHORITY: MONTE R. BULLARD LTC, MI CDR, OP GP
14. SOURCE: OTS-L-004-79	15. SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS: A SPECIFIC COMMITMENT WAS MADE TO SOURCE THAT HIS NAME WOULD NOT BE RELEASED IN CONNECTION WITH THE INFORMATION CONTAINED IN THIS IIR.	
16. SUMMARY: This IIR is a summary of an interview with a Vietnamese refugee to obtain further information regarding his claim to have knowledge of an unknown number of US PW's being held in Vietnam in 1977. The refugee in question (hereinafter referred to as "Source") speaks some English, but, being more comfortable speaking his native language, the entire interview was conducted in the Vietnamese language on the evening of 4 May 1979.		
18. DISTRIBUTION BY ORIGINATOR: DIA (original) DIA/DB-4H UNDER SEC DEF, ISA PW/MIA, RM 2C252, WASH, DC 20301 HQDA/DAMI-ISH USAOG, INSCOM, ATTN: IAFM-OPS-HUC-C	19. DOWNGRADING AND DECLASSIFICATION DATA:	20. ENCLOSURES: None
UNCLASSIFIED Classification/Control Markings		21. This IIR contains 2 pages

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1 SEPT 82 EDITION MAY BE USED UNTIL 1 MAR 77

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT		
Continuation Sheet	UNCLASSIFIED	Report No. 2 240 5001 79 Page 2 of 2 pages Originator SEEK, INSCOM
(Leave Blank)		
22. DETAILS		
1. Background:		
a. In September 1975, Source's mother's younger brother, named SSC, visited Source and his mother in SD, where they were living at the time. Mr. SSC is reportedly the man who captured and assassinated <i>Don / NAME</i> during the days of the resistance against the French. Though he was one of the highest ranking men during the resistance, when he went to the North he only attained the rank of colonel, because he was a <i>SSD</i> <i>a</i> <i>SSD</i>. While in the North, he was an officer in the armed Border Security Police and had been at the Border Security Police Training Center near SON TAY during the US raid to release US PW's from that facility. Source had a great interest in that raid due to his reading on the subject, so the conversation led to a discussion of the US PW release (see paragraph 2.a. below). b. In the spring of 1977, Source visited a friend who lives in THI NGHE, near SAIGON. His friend's uncle, called SSC (NFI), who held the rank of captain, was visiting at the time, and Source was able to talk with him for a short time.		
2. Information on US PW's:		
a. Source's uncle (see paragraph 1.a. above) and Source were talking about the US raid on the SON TAY internment facility. Source asked his uncle if all the US PW's had been returned to the US as yet. His uncle laughed and said "How could we release them all? The Americans have promised to help the North rebuild, and we are keeping some of them to use in trading for aid." b. Source's friend's uncle (see paragraph 1.b. above) claimed to be the camp commander of the 40 Inter-Zone Prison Camp (probably located in southern North Vietnam, perhaps in Quang Binh Province), where US PW's were being held at that time (NFI).		
ORIGINATOR'S COMMENTS:		
a. Source volunteered the information contained in this IIR in response to an appeal published in various Vietnamese language periodicals by the National League of Families of PW's and MIA's in Southeast Asia (see enclosure 1 to IIR 2 201 8201 79; "Alleged Sightings of US Prisoners of War in Vietnam"). Source was advised of the provisions of the Privacy Act prior to the interview. b. Source was very cooperative and related all the information he had on US PW's in Vietnam. However, Source had seen no US PW's himself, and all information above is hearsay in nature.		
UNCLASSIFIED		

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1 SEP 78 EDITION MAY BE USED UNTIL 1 MAY 79

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U-56,229/DB-4H

Memorandum for Record:

13 July 1979

SUBJECT: Forwarding of Refugee Information to the Vietnamese Government

On 11 July 1979, the attached narrative of information provided by Indochinese refugees was forwarded to the State Department for transmission. This narrative as well as other material will be presented on 10 - 12 August 1979 to the Vietnamese Government by the House Subcommittee on Asian & Pacific Affairs.

Salvatore M. Ferro
SALVATORE M. FERRO
Intelligence Research Specialist
DB-4H

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LIVE SIGHTING REPORT

Several refugees have reported that SRV officials personally told them that American PWs were still being held captive by the SRV.



DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
US ARMY OPERATIONAL GROUP
US ARMY INTELLIGENCE AND SECURITY COMMAND
FORT GEORGE G. MEADE, MARYLAND 20755

IAGPC-OPS

8 May 1979

SUBJECT: Interview With Vietnamese Refugee Re: US PW Sighting in VM

Director
Defense Intelligence Agency
ATTN: D04E
Washington, DC 20301

Inclosed memorandum transmitted as item pertaining to the interview
of Vietnamese refugee regarding US PW/MIA in Southeast Asia.

FOR THE COMMANDER:

1 Incl

John S. Keener
J. MC GUINNESS
MAJ(P), MI
Operations Officer

CP:
HQDA (DAMI-ISH)
ADCSOPS-HUMINT

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7 May 1979

MEMORANDUM FOR DIRECTOR DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE AGENCY

SUBJECT: Interview with Vietnamese Refugee Re: US Prisoners in SRV

1. REFERENCES:

a. Interservice Support Agreement W7362L-78226-002.

b. DA Letter (DAMI-ISH), Subject: Refugee Reports of US Persons in Indochina, dated 5 August 1978.

2. This memorandum is a summary of an interview with a Vietnamese refugee to obtain further information regarding his claim to have knowledge of an unknown number of US PW's being held in Vietnam in 1977. The refugee in question (hereinafter referred to as 'Source') speaks some English, but, being more comfortable speaking his native language, the entire interview was conducted by the undersigned in the Vietnamese language on the evening of 4 May 1979, at Source's home.

3. SUMMARY OF INTERVIEW:

a. Background.

(1) In September 1975, Source's mother's younger brother, named SSc, visited Source and his mother in SD where they were living at the time. Mr. SSc is reportedly the man who captured and assassinated Data during the days of the resistance against the French. Though he was one of the highest ranking men during the resistance, when he went to the North he only attained the rank of colonel, because he was a SSc. While in the North, he was an officer in the armed Border Security Police and had been at the Border Security Police Training Center near SON TAY during the US raid to release US PW's from that facility. Source had a great interest in that raid due to his reading on the subject, so the conversation led to a discussion of the US PW-release (see paragraph 3b(1), below).

(2) In the spring of 1977, Source visited a friend who lives in THI NGHE, near SAIGON. His friend's uncle, called SSc (NFI), who held the rank of captain, was visiting at the time, and Source was able to talk with him for a short time.

b. Information on US PW's:

(1) Source's uncle (see paragraph 3a(1), above) and Source were talking about the US raid on the SON TAY internment facility. Source asked his uncle if all the US PW's had been returned to the US as yet. His uncle laughed and said "How could we release them all? The Americans have promised to help the North rebuild, and we are keeping some of them to use in trading for aid."

7 May 1979

Subject: Interview with Vietnamese Refugee Re: US Prisoners in SRV

(2) Source's friend's uncle (see paragraph 3a(2), above) claimed to be the camp commander of the SSc Inter-zone Prison Camp (probably located in southern North Vietnam, perhaps in Quang Binh Province), where US PW's were being held at that time (NFI).

4. Source was very cooperative, but the above hearsay information is all that he knew on the subject of US PW's in Vietnam. However, due to the fact that the GSRV has not indicated that they still retain US PW's, and have stated strongly that they do not. They would not be in any position to make use of 'trading materials' which they claim not to possess. Due to the number of reports, however, this does seem to be a prevalent rumor in Vietnam currently.

William G. Hutchinson
WILLIAM G. HUTCHINSON
GS-11
Project Officer

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1/12/79

1/12/79



DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE AGENCY
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20301

EVALUATION OF INFORMATION
PROVIDED BY VIETNAMESE
REFUGEE SC

SC arrived in the US in April 1978.

While in Vietnam he has met two persons who came from North Vietnam following the fall of Saigon.

1/ His maternal uncle, communist party member from the South who rallied to the North in 1954 and now came back for a visit with his sister who is the mother of SC. In the course of conversation he uncle indicated that the government had kept from 200 to 3000 American POWs to bargain for aid when such negotiations takes place. His uncle was a security officer for the borders at that time; after his transfer to the South he works as a Comptroller in HCM city.

2/ Two other Northern officers, one Captain and a Colonel by the name of SSC he served in the Oil/gas department and while he was visiting his nephew in the south, he also said that the government still keeps that number in case there will be negotiations for aid, they will have something to bargain with.

Especially, the Captain was a warden in a prison for POWs in North Vietnam. SC said he did not suspect he would escape, otherwise, he would have asked about the location of the detention centers.

SC believes that all the three men were telling the truth because of the circumstances in which the info was given.

Recommendation: To have DIA official contact SC for detail. I have written to him to ask him to see a DIA official. (1/17/79) No reply yet. SC did not mention it, but I believe that because his uncle and the other officers were still in Vietnam, it is preferable to keep confidentiality.

Lo Thi Anh

SC reported that while in captivity in Attapeu, Laos during 1976, he heard information regarding the capture of four Americans. The report indicated that, in January 1976, the Pathet Lao captured two white and two black American males in Laos, near the Vietnamese border on the main road connecting Kontum, Vietnam, with Attapeu, Laos. Allegedly, all four of the Americans were wearing military uniforms, but were not armed. No further descriptive information was provided. The Americans reportedly had their hands tied and were led through a number of villages in Attapeu Province. It was further alleged that the Americans were turned over to Vietnamese soldiers who were going to take them to Hanoi. SC claimed that his story could be substantiated by a friend of his who was once assigned to France in a diplomatic capacity.

SC's friend, currently residing in Abidjan where he is an instructor of mathematics in the School of Public Engineering, was subsequently contacted. He stated that he had known SC when the two of them were prisoners together at a Vietnamese camp in the vicinity of Kontum during 1975 to 1976. Following his (the friend's) release from that camp, he went to Laos where he was apprehended by Pathet Laos forces and detained for a year and a half at a camp near Attapeu. During his detainment there, he did recall hearing a version of the incident related by SC; however, he did not give much credence to the information. To quote his words "there were always stories like that in all the internment camps." In retrospect, he stated that he still does not put much credence in the story. He himself never saw any Americans at any time. It should be noted that SC's friend, a former high diplomatic official in the Lon Nol Government, is reported to be a serious individual, not given to idle speculation.

Regarding SC's report, there were no US personnel captured in Laos during 1976.

sent to DIA on 1/27/79

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DIA FOR DB-4 & AM-2: CDR JCRC FOR CDD:

SUBJ: REQUEST FOR ASSISTANCE (U)

REF: DIA MSG DTG 132012Z FEB 79, SAME SUBJ.

1. (U) SSC INTERVIEWED 0474
CONCERNING ALLEGED SIGHTING OF
CAPTIVE AMERICANS IN LAOS JANUARY 1976.

2. (U) IN-RESPONSE REF, SSC STATED THAT HE KNEW
SC WHEN THE TWO WERE PRISONERS TOGETHER AT A
VIETNAMESE CAMP VIC KONTUM 1975-1976. SSC HAD BEEN
INTERVIEWED THERE BY VIETNAMESE AUTHORITIES UPON FLEEING
PHNOM PENH CAMBODIA IN APRIL 1975. SSC REPORTS
BEING RELEASED FROM THE KONTUM CAMP ON 14/75
AND PROCEEDING TO WALK TO
SAVANNAKHET LAOS WHERE HE HOPED TO OBTAIN FRENCH ASSIS-
TANCE AND A VISA FOR FRANCE. UPON GAINING LAOS HE
WAS INTERVIEWED BY PATHET LAO FORCES AND DETAINED FOR ONE
AND A HALF YEARS AT A CAMP NEAR ATTAPU. THE CAMP WAS
FOR CIVILIANS AND WAS COLOCATED WITH ANOTHER FOR MILI-
TARY. HE DOES RECALL HAVING HEARD AT THAT TIME A
VERSION OF THE INCIDENT RELATED REF, BUT DID NOT PUT
MUCH CREDENCE IN IT. IN HIS WORDS, "THERE WERE ALWAYS

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

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STORIES LIKE THAT IN ALL THE INTERNMENT CAMPS." IN
RETROSPECT, HE STILL DOES NOT PUT MUCH CREDENCE IN THE
STORY. AT NO TIME DID HE HIMSELF EVER SEE ANY AMERICANS.
ON 07 HE WAS RELEASED FROM THE ATTAPU DETEN-
TION CENTER AND WENT TO SAVANNAKHET WHERE AFTER ANOTHER
BRIEF DETENTION, HE DID IN FACT OBTAIN A FRENCH VISA,
ARRIVING PARIS SHORTLY THEREAFTER.

3. (U) REGRET DELAYED RESPONSE, BUT FRENCH ADDRESS FOR

PROVIDED REF PROVED TO BE CONSIDERABLY OUT OF
DATE. SSC CURRENTLY RESIDES IN , COTE
D'IVOIRE WHERE HE IS AN INSTRUCTOR OF MATHEMATICS IN
THE DATA HIS
ADDRESS IS:

4. (U) SSC IS SPENDING HIS SUMMER LEAVE
HERE IN FRANCE AND CAN BE CONTACTED
BY THIS OFFICE UP UNTIL SEPTEMBER SHOULD THE NEED ARISE.
AFTER THAT DATE, SUGGEST ANY CORRESPONDANCE/MESSAGES
BE DIRECTED TO U.S. EMBASSY, ABIDJAN WHERE
REPORTS HAVING SOME ACQUAINTANCE WITH U.S. AMBASSADOR
STEARNS.

5. BIO NOTE: SSC WAS APPARENTLY WHEN
CULTURAL ATTACHE PARIS VICE FIRST SECRETARY IN REPORT-
ED REF.

SSC APPEARS TO
BE A SERIOUS INDIVIDUAL NOT GIVEN TO IDLE SPECULATION.

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ANNOTES

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